

software like Irfan View (be it Windows or Mac), the change over isn't very smooth. For someone who has always used iWork and Microsoft Office suites, this is a change. Secondly, being heavily reliant on Dropbox shifting everything over to Google Drive is another step that you really have to take.

Cannot neglect the sheer advantages

As an OS, Chrome has its distinct advantages. It is simple, uncluttered, and to the point. On it's part, there are no pretensions of taking on Windows or OS X, and that is what makes this new platform so enticing. Chrome OS is meant for a very specific task, mind you. It's ideal for someone who is already using the Google ecosystem – browser, Mail, Drive etc., for their work. And also for someone who needs a simple to use laptop for web browsing, accessing emails, streaming media and playing the odd casual game.

Made up your mind? Memorize these shortcuts!

Since it is a new platform, getting used to how it works will take time. Given that reality, we have listed out five critical keyboard shortcuts that you must memorize (or pin up near the workstation!), to have a smoother transition.

Minimize Window - Ctrl + M

Quickly switching between windows? Minimize one quickly with this command to not waste time dragging the cursor over to the app icon.

Lock the screen - Ctrl + Shift + L

Leaving the desk in a hurry? This quick shortcut locks the display, and you will be able to unlock it, once you return, with your Google account password.

Task Manager - Shift + Esc

While we never once needed to view the task manager during our time with the Chromebook, if you notice that your Chromebook's performance has suddenly degraded, or the battery discharge is quicker than usual, you might want to check if an app is misbehaving. This command will open the task manager, showing each app's memory consumption, CPU use etc.

Toggle Caps Lock On/Off - Alt + Search

Well, this applies if you haven't changed the search key's behaviour in the settings. By default, as the name and the indicator suggests, the Search key opens the search tool. But, it sits exactly where the Caps Lock key sits on